

Jan Zilinsky

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, New York University	2022
M.B.A., University of Chicago	2014
B.A., Economics, Harvard University	2009

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Technical University of Munich	Oct. 2021 - Sept. 2026
Postdoctoral Research Affiliate, NYU Center for Social Media, AI, and Politics	2022 - 2026
Günther Thiele Fellow, Leipzig University	May 2026
Researcher, Slovak Academy of Sciences	Dec. 2024 - June 2026
Data Fellow, New York University	2020
Research Analyst, Peterson Institute for International Economics	2014-16

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- [19] Artificial Intelligence, Social Media, and the Politics of Anti-Technology (with T. Zeitzoff). Accepted and forthcoming. *American Journal of Political Science*.
- [18] Ideology and free speech values predict content moderation preferences: cross-national evidence across targets of hate speech (with Y. Theocharis, S. Kosmidis, and F. Quint). 2026. *Scientific Reports*.
- [17] Can AI-Attributed News Challenge Partisan News Selection? Evidence from a Conjoint Experiment (with A. Zoizner et al.) 2025. *The International Journal of Press/Politics*.
- [16] Conspiracism and Government Distrust Predict COVID-19 Vaccine Refusal (with Y. Theocharis). 2025. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.
- [15] Economic Evaluations and Partisan Faultfinding (with J. Bisbee). 2025. *Political Science Research and Methods*.
- [14] Explaining 2020 Trump Support: The Role of Anti-Muslim, Pro-Police, and Anti-BLM Attitudes (with N. Lajevardi). 2025. *Electoral Studies*.
- [13] The Trump Advantage in Policy Recall Among Voters (with J.A. Tucker and J. Nagler). 2025. *American Politics Research*, 53(2), pp. 91-102.
- [12] Justifying an Invasion: When is Disinformation Successful? (First author, with 23 co-authors.) 2024. *Political Communication*, 41(6), pp. 965-986.
- [11] Toxic Speech and Limited Demand for Content Moderation on Social Media (with F. Pradel, Y. Theocharis & S. Kosmidis). 2024. *American Political Science Review*, 118(4), pp. 1895-1912.
- [10] Left-Right Political Orientations Are Not Systematically Related to Conspiracism (with A. Enders, C. Klostad, S. Littrell, J. Miller, Y. Theocharis & J. Uscinski). 2024. *Advances in Political Psychology*.
- [9] Donate to help us fight back: Political fundraising and toxic rhetoric online (with S.S. Kim & B. Brew). 2024. *Party Politics*.
- [8] Beliefs in Conspiracy Theories and Online News Consumption During the Pandemic (with S. Jin, F. Pradel and Y. Theocharis). 2024. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, (4)1.

- [7] Division Does Not Imply Predictability: Demographics Continue to Reveal Little About Voting and Partisanship (with S.S. Kim). 2024. *Political Behavior*, (46)1, pp. 67–87.
- [6] Exposure to the Russian Internet Research Agency foreign influence campaign on Twitter in the 2016 US election and its relationship to attitudes and voting behavior (with G. Eady, T. Paskhalis, R. Bonneau, J. Nagler and J.A. Tucker). 2023. *Nature Communications*. 14(62), pp. 1–11.

As of May 2026, this article is in the 99th percentile (ranked 142nd of the 516,336 tracked articles of a similar age in all journals) and the 99th percentile (ranked 6th of the 1,686 tracked articles) of a similar age in Nature Communications, reflecting exceptional public and media impact tracked via news outlets, social media, and Wikipedia citations.

- [5] Geographic Boundaries and Local Economic Conditions Matter for Views of the Economy (with J. Bisbee). 2023. *Political Analysis*. 31(2), pp. 288–294.
- [4] Don't Republicans Tweet Too? Using Twitter to Assess the Consequences of Political Endorsements by Celebrities (with C. Vaccari, J. Nagler and J.A. Tucker). 2020. *Perspectives on Politics*, (18)1, pp. 144–160.
- [3] Democratic deconsolidation revisited: Young Europeans are not dissatisfied with democracy. 2019. *Research & Politics*. (6)1.
- [2] How Many People Live in Political Bubbles on Social Media? Evidence From Linked Survey and Twitter Data (with G. Eady, J. Nagler, A. Guess and J.A. Tucker). 2019. *SAGE Open*, (9)1.
- [1] The Happiness Gap in Eastern Europe (with S. Djankov and E. Nikolova). 2016. *Journal of Comparative Economics*, (44)1, pp. 108–124.

FIELD RECOGNITION: FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

Swedish Research Council (Vetenskapsrådet), Strategic Recruitment Grant, 2026–31	approx. \$1,559,000 (15 million SEK)
Fellowship for Excellent Researchers, EU Recovery and Resilience Plan, 2024–26	€58,705
Best Conference Paper Award, American Political Science Assoc. Information Technology and Politics Division, 2025	
TUM Global Initiative (with Y. Theocharis), 2025	€10,000
Good Authority Fellowship, 2025	\$2,500
TUM award to design a new university course <i>AI, Society and Governance</i> , 2024	€6,638
HfP Seed Funding Grant, 2024	€5,000
The Center for Growth and Opportunity Research Grant (with T. Zeitzoff), 2023	\$18,000
Reboot Social Media grant, TUM Think Tank (with 3 co-principal investigators), 2022–24	€35,500
MacCracken Fellowship, 2016–21	approx. \$150,000
Craig Newmark Fellowship, 2020	approx. \$14,000
Shelby Davis Scholar	\$40,000
<i>Other:</i> NYU Provost's Global Research Initiatives Fellowship, George Downs Prize (NYU Department of Politics), Fama-Miller Center Research Grant, University of Chicago Booth School of Business Graduate Fellowship, Oscar Mayer Fellowship, Marshall Goldman grant (Davis Center for Russian and Eurasian Studies, Harvard University)	

CONTRIBUTIONS TO RESEARCH AND ACADEMIC COMMUNITIES

Editorial Board Member, *Political Communication*

Editorial Board Member, *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*

Peer reviewer:

American Political Science Review	The International Journal of Press/Politics
Journal of Politics	Mass Communication and Society
Political Analysis	European Political Science Review
Political Behavior	Journal of Political Marketing
Political Communication	Humanities and Social Sciences Communications
Nature Human Behavior	Scientific Data
Public Opinion Quarterly	Politics & Gender
Political Psychology	German Politics
Political Science Research and Methods	Democratization
Journal of Experimental Political Science	Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
Scientific Reports	Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization
Electoral Studies	Applied Economics Letters
PNAS Nexus	Kyklos
PLOS One	

APSA Information Technology and Politics award committee member, 2026

Graduate admissions committee member, Technical University of Munich, 2024-26

Co-organizer of the TUM-Georgetown Workshop on the evolution of digital platforms, May 2025

Coordinator of Munich Data Science Lightning Talks, 2024

Chair and discussant at APSA and MPSA annual meetings (various years)

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

Hertie School Political Economy Seminar	2026 (scheduled)
Leipzig University	2026
University of Manchester	2026
University of Miami	2026
Oxford Internet Institute	2025
University of South Carolina	2025
University of Innsbruck	2025
University of Houston	2025
Royal Holloway Workshop	2025
University of Southern Denmark	2025
Slovak Academy of Sciences	2025
EPFL Center for Digital Trust (Impact of AI on Elections and Public Perceptions)	2024
Bundeswehr University	2024
VŠE Prague Research Seminar Series in Economics	2024
Zurich Disinformation Workshop (invited presentation)	2023
ETH Zurich (virtual presentation)	2022

Presentations at Conferences and Workshops

International Society of Political Psychology	2026
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Politics of AI Workshop at the Midwest Political Science Association conference	2026
American Political Science Association Annual Meetings	2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Midwest Political Science Association	2018, 2019, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2026
European Political Science Association	2022, 2023
APSA PolComm pre-conference	2023, 2025
Zurich Digital Democracy Workshop	2025
Tilburg Law and Economics Center	2025
TUM-Georgetown workshop	2025
Society for Political Methodology meetings: MENA/Asian PolMeth meeting (NYU Abu Dhabi)	2024
PolMeth Europe	2021
EUI Workshop on Political Behaviour in Central and Eastern Europe	2024
Annual Meeting of the German Political Psychology Network	2024
TUM Think Tank workshop on disinformation	2024
CSMaP Annual Conference in Florence	2023
University of Miami Conspiracy Theory conference	2023
World Association for Public Opinion Research annual conference (WAPOR)	2023
International Communication Association in Washington D.C.	2019
Toronto Political Behavior Workshop	2019
Economic Science Association conference	2019
NYU Abu Dhabi Winter Experimental Social & Sciences Institute	2019
PolMeth Annual Meeting in Provo (poster)	2018
University of Zurich Technocratic Challenge to Democracy workshop	2017

TEACHING

Technical University of Munich (instructor)

AI, Society and Governance, 2024-26	Instructor rating: 5/5
R and Data Visualization, 2022-26	Instructor rating: 4,9/5
Political Information in the Digital Age, 2021-24	Instructor rating: 4,7/5
Campaigns, Elections, and Social Media, 2022-23	Instructor rating: 4,7/5
Seminar on Applications of Behavioral Economics to Politics, 2021-22	Instructor rating: 4,9/5

Teaching assistantships and fellowships

- New York University: Inequality, Populism and Voting (Nagler), Introduction to Political Theory (Landa), Politics Senior Honors (Harvey & Dawes).
- *University of Chicago, Booth School of Business*: Big Data (Taddy).
- *Harvard University*: Psychology and Economics (Laibson and Shleifer), Dealing with the Global Financial Crisis (Rogoff), Principles of Economics (Laibson, Acemoglu, List, and Watson)

SELECTED MEDIA COVERAGE

- Die Ziet (a German national weekly newspaper)
- Süddeutsche Zeitung (largest non-tabloid daily newspaper in Germany)

- Weekendavisen (a Danish weekly broadsheet newspaper)
- Various US news outlets (Reason Magazine, Vox.com, SciTechDaily, and others)
- Dennik N and SME (national newspapers in Slovakia)

SELECTED PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

Very few Americans support actual political violence. Many more support intimidation. *Good Authority*, 2025.

The Epstein files have managed to unite liberal and conservative media. *Good Authority*, 2025.

Good to Know: Anti-establishment orientation. *Good Authority*, 2025.

Content Warning: Public Attitudes on Content Moderation and Freedom of Expression. With Y. Theocharis, S. Kosmidis, F. Quint, & F. Pradel. *TUM Think Tank Report*, 2025.

Is the FBI impartial? Over half of Republicans say ‘no.’ With S. Kates, J. A. Tucker and J. Ladd. *The Washington Post Monkey Cage*, 2022

Did Trump keep his campaign promises? Here’s what Americans think. With J. Nagler, and J. A. Tucker. *The Washington Post Monkey Cage*, 2020

Why didn’t more congressional Republicans condemn Trump’s racist tweets about the ‘Squad’? This graph explains. *The Washington Post Monkey Cage*, 2019.

REFERENCES

Jonathan Nagler, Professor of Politics and Data Science, New York University, jonathan.nagler@nyu.edu

Joshua A. Tucker, Professor of Politics and Data Science, New York University, joshua.tucker@nyu.edu

Yannis Theocharis, Chair of Digital Governance, Technical University of Munich, yannis.theocharis@hfp.tum.de

Robert Kubinec, Associate Professor of Political Science, Texas A&M University, bob.kubinec@tamu.edu

Spyros Kosmidis, Associate Professor, University of Oxford, spyros.kosmidis@politics.ox.ac.uk

John V. Kane, Associate Professor, New York University, jvk221@nyu.edu